American forces operating in Afghanistan. Lives, American lives are at stake and we do not know what is happening.

The American Government says it has a plan for the FATA. And the plan as it was briefed to me is approximately $750 million over 5 years for reconstruction. This was presented to me with some pride by American officials at a very high level. I would submit to you and your colleagues that this is a pathetic amount of money: $150 million a year for reconstruction when everyone agrees that this area is a part of the Afghan theater of operations. You have been authorizing billions of dollars for Afghanistan, and I support that, and yet the State Department and the administration have asked for less than, for less than 5 percent of that money for this all-important area.

Furthermore, the bulk of this money will never reach Pakistan. And I want to stress this to all of you. The system that this administration has put into place, which is essentially to privatize foreign policy, allows, and particularly foreign assistance, means that you will give the money to the State Department or AID, they will contract with NGOs and consultant groups, not necessarily non-profits either, in the United States, and those groups will find subcontractors on the ground in Pakistan. And nobody in the Embassy in Islamabad will know where this money is going. You will not know where it is going. I have been reliably told that a very substantial percentage of it never leaves the United States, it goes into overhead. And I would respectfully recommend to your committee that you hold separate hearings on this question because it is not restricted just to Pakistan. And the American taxpayers are losing billions of dollars. And even more important than the waste, we have no idea how the money is being used.

I sat next to the Minister of Education of one of the states at a dinner in Peshawar. And she was just leaving the government. And I said, ''What are you going to do?'' And she said, ''I am going to go back to my NGO.'' And she will be the recipient of some of this money. She was a very impressive person; I do not mean to criticize her. But none of you in this room and no one in Washington will know what her personal politics are, how the money would go.

Last, on Afghanistan itself, with your permission I would like to submit five articles, four of which I wrote recently, and the fifth of which was written by my chief of staff Ashley Baumer, about the Afghan-Pakistan area.

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